

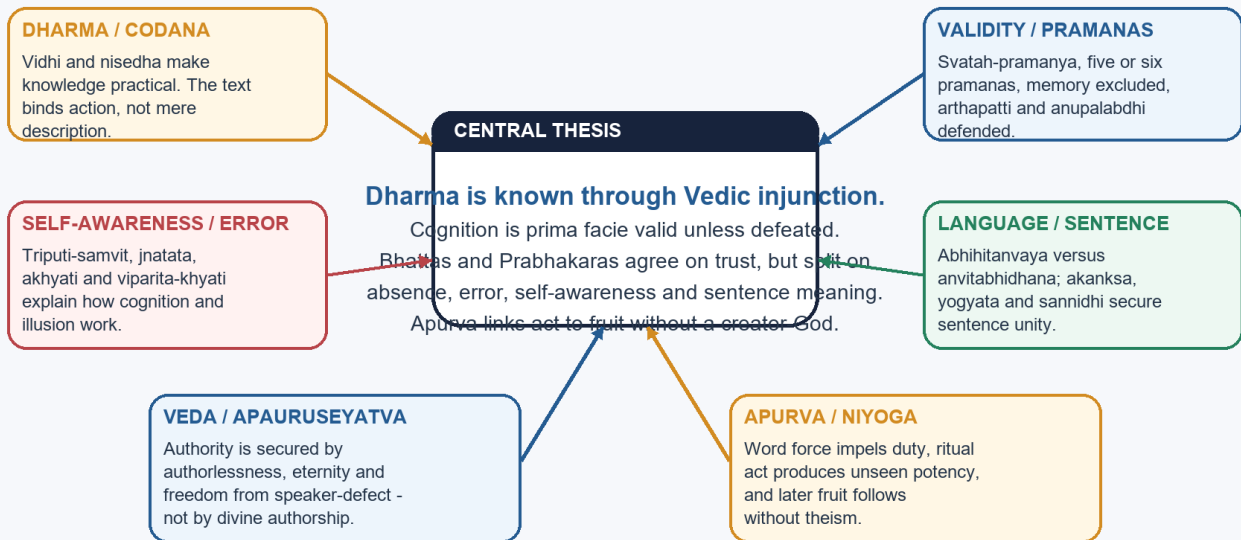
COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

MIMAMSA - Layered Complete Learning Session - Syllabus Item 18

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

MIMAMSA: KNOWLEDGE IN DEFENCE OF DHARMA

Validity, language, injunction, absence, error and apurva in one exam map



SPINE: default trust -> special pramanas -> language and injunction -> apurva -> criticism and graded validity

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

MIMAMSA - Layered Complete Learning Session - Syllabus Item 18

Syllabus (verbatim): Mimamsa: Theory of Knowledge. **Source order actually used:** canonical owner paper -1/indian/Mimamsa.md; local OCR-searchable Chatterjee-Datta, C.D. Sharma and Radhakrishnan chapters; official contemporary linkage from Central Sanskrit University; Qdrant not required. **Source limitation:** OCR noise in the local philosophy scans was cross-checked against the canonical owner and the verified PYQ ledger. No noisy OCR sentence is reproduced as a quotation. **Evidence key:** FACT: direct source or canonical doctrine · ANALYSIS: analysis, comparison or evaluative synthesis · CAUTION: contested or development-stage claim.

How to use this layered session

Every logical subtopic follows the Philosophy five-layer sequence:

Layer	Purpose
1. SIMPLE START	Plain-language visual gateway
2. CORE UPSC	Complete retained doctrine, terminology, arguments and examples
3. ADVANCED	Objections, replies, comparisons and qualified evaluation
4. EXAM APPLICATION	Verified PYQ routing and marks-wise answer structure
5. RAPID REVISION	Traps, recall spines and mastery preparation

Source audit: the canonical Mimamsa knowledge file and complete 2018-2025 Indian Philosophy PYQ bank were checked. The source session's direct OCR anchors to Chatterjee-Datta, C. D. Sharma and Radhakrishnan are retained. The official Central Sanskrit University 2026-27 programme and Sanskrit-promotion context was rechecked and is used only as educational linkage, not as proof of classical doctrine. Qdrant was not required.

Preservation note: every substantive section of the earlier complete session is retained. The new material adds simple visual gateways and explicit learning layers without replacing or compressing the original depth.

Progress: 1 / 8 | Philosophy Layered Session | Subtopic: The Mimamsa Project: Knowledge in the Service of Dharma

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Plain-language visual - from command to delayed result

VEDIC INJUNCTION
|
reveals what ought to be done
|
qualified agent performs the rite
|
APURVA carries efficacy beyond the visible act
|
promised fruit matures later

In simple words: Mimamsa asks how supersensible duty can be known and how a temporary ritual act can produce a later result. Its epistemology and language theory protect this action-guiding role of the Veda.

Term	Easy meaning
Dharma	Supersensible duty
Codana / vidhi	Vedic injunction
Bhavana	Impelling and productive force
Niyoga	Binding to-be-done

Term	Easy meaning
Apurva	Unseen link between act and fruit

Memory line: Mimamsa is knowledge organised around duty and action.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

0. ONE-SCREEN MAP

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MIMAMSA = inquiry into dharma through Vedic injunction
|
+-- REALIST BACKGROUND
|   +-- real world, enduring self, karmic continuity
|
+-- EPISTEMIC THESIS
|   +-- svatah-pramanya = validity intrinsic
|   +-- paratah-apramanya = invalidity discovered later
|
+-- PRAMANAS
|   +-- Prabhakara: 5
|   +-- Bhatta: 6 (adds anupalabdhi)
|
+-- KEY SPECIALTIES
|   +-- arthapatti = compelled postulation
|   +-- anupalabdhi = knowledge of absence
|   +-- akhyati vs viparita-khyati
|   +-- triputi-samvit vs jnatata
|   +-- abhihitavaya vs anvitabhidhana
|
+-- HERMENEUTIC GOAL
|   +-- codana -> duty -> action -> apurva -> fruit
|
+-- VEDIC CLAIM
|   +-- Veda is apauruseya, eternal, self-valid for dharma

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FACT: The school is not "ritualism plus a few epistemic ideas." Its epistemology, semantics and anti-theistic theology are all designed to secure objective knowledge of dharma.

1. ORIENTATION, TEXTS, AND THINKERS

FACT: **Pūrva-Mīmāṃsā** is earlier than Uttara-Mīmāṃsā primarily in a **logical** sense: it begins with duty, injunction and ritual action, whereas Vedānta begins with ultimate reality. Chatterjee and Datta explicitly describe Mīmāṃsā as serving ritualism in **two ways** - by offering a method of Vedic interpretation and by supplying a philosophical justification of the faith presupposed by ritual action.

FACT: The intellectual center is **dharma-jijñāsā**. Jaimini's project is not to speculate first about God or Brahman, but to ask how duty is known, how injunction binds, how ritual yields fruit, and why Vedic testimony should be trusted when dharma is supersensible.

Thinker / text	Role in the system	What to remember for UPSC
Jaimini - Mīmāṃsā-sūtra	foundational statement of dharma-jijñāsā	codana- laksano 'r tho dharmah is the governing formula
Śabara - Śābara-bhāṣya	classical base commentary	later debate takes shape through his exegetical frame
Kumārila Bhaṭṭa	Bhāṭṭa line; stronger realist and polemical style	six pramāṇas, anupalabdhi, jñātātā, viparīta-khyāti
Prabhākara Miśra	Prābhākara line; greater economy	five pramāṇas, tripuṭi-samvit, akhyāti, anvitābhidhāna

Thinker / text	Role in the system	What to remember for UPSC
Later manual writers	systematizers and transmitters	Parthasārathi, Śālikanātha and later digests help with technical vocabulary

ANALYSIS: Radhakrishnan and Sharma both show the same broad pattern: **the school shares realism, Vedic authority and intrinsic validity, but splits sharply on absence, error, self-awareness and sentence meaning.** That unity-in-difference is the safest exam posture.

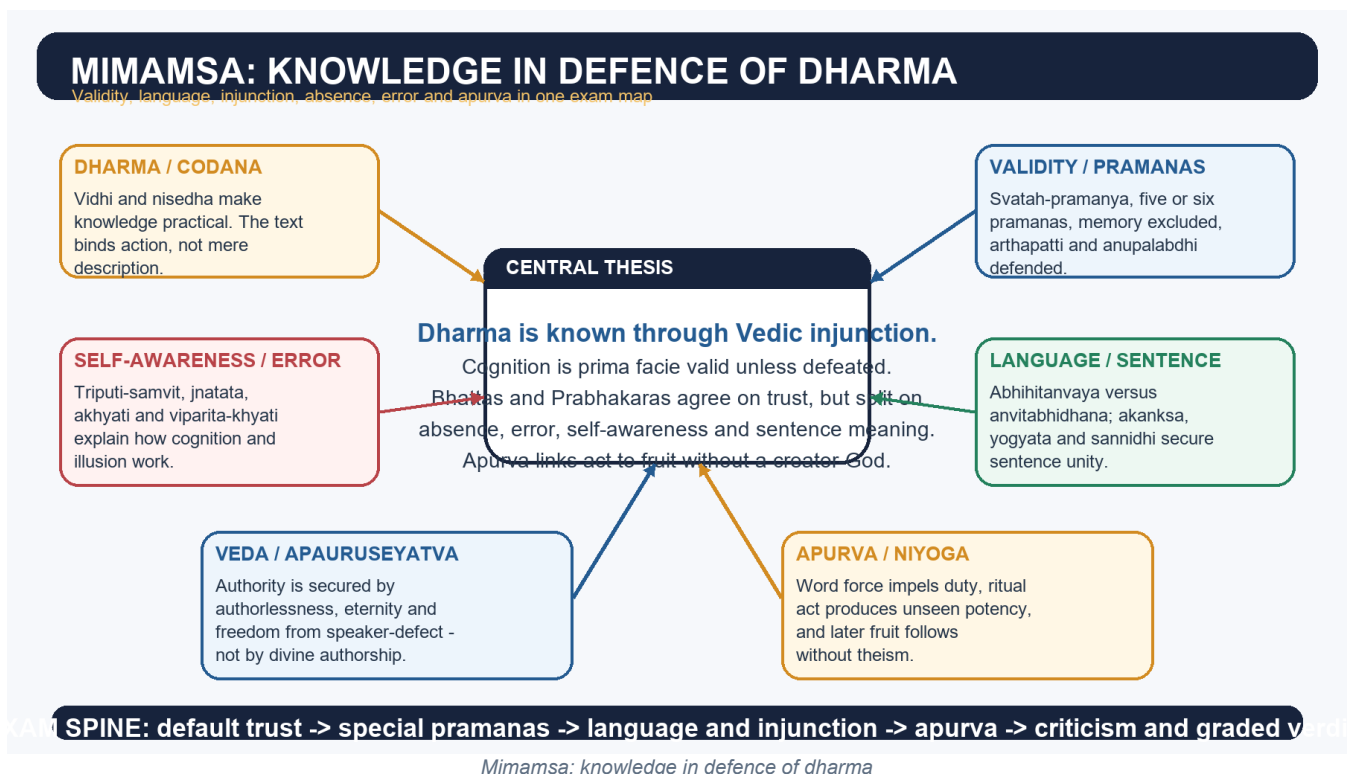
1.1 Why Mimamsa is a major UPSC topic

1. FACT: It gives the strongest Indian defense of **default trust in cognition**.
2. FACT: It refuses to reduce all mediate knowledge to inference, thereby protecting **arthāpatti** and, for Bhāṭṭa, **anupalabdhi**.
3. FACT: It connects epistemology to **language, injunction, ritual efficacy**, and **textual interpretation**.
4. FACT: It offers a strikingly **orthodox yet anti-theistic** model: Veda is secured not by God, but by authorlessness.
5. FACT: Recent UPSC papers repeatedly ask the internal Bhāṭṭa-Prābhākara debates, not generic summary alone.

1.2 Minimal metaphysical background

- FACT: The world is real, not a mere appearance or projection.
- FACT: The self is enduring enough to be knower, doer and enjoyer.
- FACT: Karma must connect an act and its later fruit.
- FACT: Dharma is supersensible and therefore unavailable to mere perception.
- FACT: Hence epistemology, semantics and ritual hermeneutics are structurally connected.

2. VISUAL - KNOWLEDGE IN DEFENCE OF DHARMA



The visual keeps the whole optional route in view: epistemology protects Vedic authority, Vedic authority grounds duty, duty becomes action through injunction, and action yields fruit through apurva without needing a creator-God.

3. DHARMA, CODANA, VIDHI, APURVA, BHAVANA, NIYOGA

FACT: **Jaimini's formula:** codana - laksano 'rtho dharmah - dharma is that end or object characterized by Vedic injunction.

3.1 Dharma is known as what ought to be done

FACT: Mīmāṃsā does not define dharma as bare moral feeling. It defines dharma as what the Veda **enjoins**. Therefore its central sentence-type is **vidhi** (injunction), complemented by **niṣedha** (prohibition).

Term	Meaning	Why it matters
Dharma	supersensible duty known through Vedic injunction	gives the entire school its objective
Codanā / vidhi	impelling Vedic command	makes the sentence action-guiding rather than merely descriptive
Niṣedha	prohibition	marks what ought not to be done
Apūrva	unseen potency generated by correct ritual action	links a perishing act to a delayed fruit
Śābdī bhāvanā	linguistic impelling force of the injunction	explains how the word motivates action
Ārthī bhāvanā	real productive force of the agent's performance	explains how action leads to result
Niyoga	the binding "to-be-done"	central to Prābhākara duty theory

3.2 From Vedic sentence to ritual fruit

Vedic injunction heard
 ->
 qualified agent understands duty
 ->
 linguistic force (śābdī bhāvanā) produces undertaking
 ->
 ritual act is performed with proper accessories
 ->
 real productive force (ārthī bhāvanā) operates
 ->
 apūrva persists after the visible act ends
 ->
 promised fruit matures later

3.3 Bhāṭṭa versus Prābhākara on obligation

Issue	Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā	Prābhākara Mīmāṃsā
Immediate theory	Bhāvanā-vāda	Niyoga-vāda
What binds?	injunction impels action toward a desired result	injunction directly presents the act as to-be-done
Motivation	qualified desire, especially for phala such as heaven	categorical obligation for the adhikārin
Standard contrast	closer to result-oriented ritual psychology	closer to deontological duty

ANALYSIS: A controlled comparison with Kant is permissible only as a **last-line analogy**. Prābhākara duty is not grounded in autonomous rational law, but in the impersonal authority of the Veda.

3.4 Aṃśa-traya - the three questions every injunction must answer

FACT: Mīmāṃsā analyzes injunction through three factors:

1. **bhāvya / sādhya** - what is to be brought about;
2. **karāṇa / sādhana** - by what means;
3. **itikartavyatā** - how exactly it is to be done.

In svargakamo yajeta, heaven is the end, sacrifice is the means, and the whole ritual procedure gives the "how".

3.5 Vedānta objection and Mīmāṃsā reply

- WRONG: **Objection:** Upaniṣadic statements such as tat tvam asi reveal an already accomplished reality and cannot be reduced to injunction.
- FACT: **Mīmāṃsā reply:** Vedic purposiveness becomes unintelligible if scriptural meaning is detached from action. Therefore even non-injunctive passages are interpreted through their relation to ritual or contemplative practice.
- ANALYSIS: **Residual pressure:** this is exactly where Pūrva-Mīmāṃsā and Vedānta part company most sharply.

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

Advanced normativity without divine command

The school's unity lies in its governing problem. Dharma cannot be perceived, while ordinary inference cannot independently establish ritual obligation. Vedic injunction therefore supplies normative knowledge, semantics explains sentence-unity, and apurva explains delayed efficacy.

Bhatta *bhavana-vada* stresses linguistic impulsion, action and desired fruit; Prabhakara *niyoga-vada* gives greater priority to the binding character of the act as to-be-done. The difference resembles consequential and deontological emphasis only loosely because both remain grounded in impersonal Vedic authority.

Vedānta presses the deepest textual objection: some Vedic sentences reveal an accomplished reality rather than command action. Mimamsa resists detaching scriptural meaning from practical function, exposing the fault line between Pūrva and Uttara Mimamsa.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Exam route

- Open broad answers with **dharma-jijnasa through Vedic injunction**.
- Connect codana -> bhavana/niyoga -> action -> apurva -> fruit.
- Distinguish Bhatta result-oriented ritual psychology from Prabhakara's stronger duty emphasis.
- Do not present Mimamsa as ritualism with unrelated epistemology; show the structural connection.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall

- Jaimini: *Mīmāṃsa-sūtra*; Sabara: foundational commentary.
- Kumarila: Bhatta; Prabhakara: Prabhakara school.
- Dharma is known through injunction.
- Apurva explains delayed ritual efficacy without God.
- Trap: Mimamsa's primary project is not proof of Brahman or creator God.

Progress: 2 / 8 | Philosophy Layered Session | Subtopic: Intrinsic Validity and the Pramāṇa Architecture

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Plain-language visual - trust first, revise when defeated

COGNITION ARISES
|
prima facie authority
|
act on it normally
|
later contradiction or defect?
no -> remains valid
yes -> invalidity discovered externally

In simple words: Mimamsa says knowledge does not wait for a second certificate before it can guide action. Cognition is trusted by default; error is established later through defeat.

School	Pramanas
Prabhakara	5
Bhatta	6, adding anupalabdhi
Nyaya	4

Memory line: intrinsic validity is defeasible default trust, not infallibility.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

4. VALIDITY AND PRAMĀṆA ARCHITECTURE

4.1 Svataḥ-prāmāṇya and parataḥ-aprāmāṇya

FACT: Mīmāṃsā holds that cognition is **prima facie valid by its own occurrence** under normal conditions. One does not wait for a second certificate before acting. Falsity, by contrast, is detected **later** through contradiction, defect or practical defeat.

Aspect	Mimamsa claim	Meaning
Origin of validity	intrinsic	the same conditions that produce cognition produce its authority
Awareness of validity	intrinsic	cognition presents itself as trustworthy without needing prior verification
Origin of invalidity	extrinsic	falsity arises from defect, mislocation, or counterevidence
Awareness of invalidity	extrinsic	later correction, contradiction or discovery of defect reveals it

MEMORY: **Exam formula:** default validity is **not** infallibility. The doctrine says “trust first, revise when defeated,” not “whatever appears is eternally true.”

4.2 Why Mimamsa defends intrinsic validity

1. FACT: Otherwise every cognition would need another cognition to validate it.
2. FACT: The validator would itself need validation.
3. FACT: Infinite regress would follow.
4. FACT: Practical life would never begin.
5. FACT: Therefore default epistemic trust is built into cognition itself.

Chatterjee and Datta summarize the doctrine in a memorable way: **belief is normal; disbelief is exceptional.**

4.3 Nyāya contrast - parataḥ-prāmāṇya

FACT: Naiyāyikas stress successful activity, correspondence and later reflective certification. Mimamsa objects that such external validation already presupposes trust in the cognition on which one acts.

Issue	Mimamsa	Nyāya
starting status of cognition	trusted unless defeated	validated by something outside the first cognition
standard concern	anti-regress and default authority	verification, successful action, reflective certainty
major risk	critics charge gullibility	critics charge regress or hidden prior trust

4.4 The pramāṇa map

School	Accepted pramāṇas
Sāṃkhya	perception, inference, testimony
Nyāya	perception, inference, comparison, testimony
Prābhākara Mīmāṃsā	perception, inference, comparison, testimony, arthāpatti
Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā	perception, inference, comparison, testimony, arthāpatti, anupalabdhi

4.5 Why memory is not a pramāṇa

FACT: Both Prābhākara and Nyāya reject memory as a source of valid knowledge because it does **not** disclose a previously unknown object. It re-presents old content, and its dependence on prior cognition is exactly why it lacks pramāṇa-status.

Fresh cognition	Memory
reveals what is not yet known as presently cognized	depends on an earlier cognition and a residual impression
can count as pramā	can be true, but is not a pramāṇa
basis of present disclosure	basis of re-presentation

4.6 Two master warnings

1. ANALYSIS: **Svataḥ-prāmāṇya** is a thesis about **validity**, not automatically about **self-awareness**.
2. ANALYSIS: **Self-luminosity** and **intrinsic validity** often travel together, but the Bhāṭṭa position proves they are conceptually distinct.

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

Advanced regress and self-luminosity distinction

If every cognition needs another cognition to certify it, the validator itself needs certification and regress follows. Mimamsa therefore locates authority in the original cognition under normal conditions while locating falsity in later-discovered defect or contradiction.

Nyaya replies that successful action and correspondence provide external validation. Mimamsa counters that one must already trust cognition enough to initiate the validating action. The dispute concerns epistemic starting-point, not whether correction is possible.

Validity and manifestation must remain distinct. Prabhakara combines triputi self-manifestation with intrinsic validity, but Kumarila knows cognition through *jnatata* while still defending intrinsic validity. The Bhatta position decisively blocks any claim of logical entailment between self-luminosity and default authority.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Exam route

- **2018 Q8(a)**: separate self-manifestation from validity and compare Nyaya, both Mimamsa lines and Advaita.
- **2020 Q5(c), 2024 Q8(c)**: memory may be true but is not a pramana because it lacks novelty.
- **2025 Q5(c)**: compare intrinsic and extrinsic validity by origin, ascertainment, regress and correction.
- State both: svatah-pramanya and paratah-apramanya.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall

- Belief is normal; disbelief is exceptional.
- Intrinsic validity does not mean permanent truth.
- Prabhakara has five pramanas; Bhatta has six.
- Memory re-presents prior content.
- Trap: validity theory is not automatically a theory of self-awareness.

Progress: 3 / 8 | Philosophy Layered Session | Subtopic: Arthapatti and Anupalabdhi: Explanatory Necessity and Absence

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Plain-language visual - two special knowledge situations

DEVADATTA IS STOUT
+ DOES NOT EAT BY DAY
|
facts cannot stand together unaided
|
POSTULATE NIGHT EATING = ARTHAPATTI

WELL-LIT EMPTY TABLE
+ JAR WOULD BE SEEN IF PRESENT
|
JAR IS ABSENT = ANUPALABDHI

In simple words: arthapatti supplies the fact required to make accepted data coherent. Anupalabdhi knows absence when all conditions for seeing a present object are satisfied.

Memory line: explanatory compulsion is not mere guess; meaningful non-perception is not mere ignorance.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

5. ARTHĀPATTI AND ANUPALABDHI

5.1 Arthāpatti - compelled explanatory postulation

FACT: Arthāpatti is not a guess and not a loose “best explanation.” It is the **necessary postulation** of an unseen fact without which accepted facts would remain incompatible.

5.2 The Devadatta model

Known fact 1: Devadatta is stout.

Known fact 2: Devadatta does not eat during the day.

Tension: stoutness and total non-nourishment cannot stand together.

Postulate: Devadatta must eat at night.

FACT: Chatterjee and Datta distinguish **dr̥ṣṭārthāpatti** (used to explain what is observed) and **śrutārthāpatti** (used to explain what is heard). UPSC usually expects the **stout Devadatta** example first.

5.3 Why Nyāya reduction to inference is resisted

Nyāya reduction attempt	Mimamsa reply
convert the case into a universal: "all stout day-fasters eat at night"	the alleged universal is not independently known; it is extracted from the very postulational situation
treat stoutness as hetu and night-eating as sādhyā	the cognitive movement is from incompatibility to explanatory supplementation, not from sign to signified
call it a disguised inference	it lacks the standard pakṣa-hetu-sādhyā structure and depends on explanatory necessity

ANALYSIS: The safest verdict is: **arthāpatti is the epistemology of explanatory compulsion.**

5.4 The 2024 candidate-success application

FACT: If a candidate is never seen studying during the day and still tops an exam, a Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsaka postulates unseen preparation - probably night study or another unobserved time-slot. A Naiyāyika tries to reconstruct the case as inference from a rule connecting success and preparation. The question tests whether you can preserve that difference.

5.5 Anupalabdhi - knowledge of absence

FACT: **Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā** alone among the two sub-schools grants **anupalabdhi** independent pramāṇa-status. It is knowledge of absence through **non-apprehension of what would be apprehended if present.**

5.6 Yogyānupalabdhi - the limiting condition

For valid absence-cognition, the following must be in place:

1. FACT: the object must be perceptible in principle;
2. FACT: the locus must be properly available;
3. FACT: the relevant sense-organ must be functioning;
4. FACT: lighting, distance and attention must be appropriate.

Only then does non-perception justify the judgment "the book is not on the table." One cannot move from failure to see atoms to the conclusion that there are no atoms, because atoms are not perceptible objects of that kind.

5.7 Nature of abhāva and its knowledge

View	What is absent?	How known?
Bhāṭṭa	abhāva is real and structured by a counterpositive	known through anupalabdhi
Prābhākara	what is directly given is the bare locus unqualified by the missing object	no separate pramāṇa needed
Nyāya	absence is a real category	often treated as perceptible or inferable, not requiring a separate anupalabdhi

ANALYSIS: The Bhāṭṭa view pays an ontological cost - reality contains structured negatives - but it preserves the determinacy of everyday negative cognition.

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

Advanced reduction debates

Nyaya reconstructs arthapatti as inference, but Mimamsa argues that the alleged universal relation is extracted from the very explanatory tension that needs resolution. The cognition moves from incompatible accepted facts to a necessary supplement rather than from a known sign to a probandum.

Bhatta grants absence structured objecthood and an independent means of knowledge. *Yogyanupalabdhi* limits the claim: only an object perceptible under available conditions can be known absent through non-apprehension. This blocks arguments from failure to perceive intrinsically imperceptible entities.

Prabhakara explains the same case through cognition of the bare locus, while Nyaya accepts absence but resists a new pramana. Bhatta best preserves determinate negative judgment; the rivals purchase greater economy.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Exam route

- **2022 Q6(c)**: state Nyaya's inferential reduction fairly, then give incompatibility, missing vyapti and structural objections.
- **2024 Q8(b)**: apply the candidate-success example without turning arthapatti into loose speculation.
- **2021 Q6(c), 2023 Q6(b), 2025 Q6(c)**: define abhava, yogyata and the Bhatta-Prabhakara divide.
- Always state what would be perceived if present.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall

- Arthapatti = compelled explanatory postulation.
- Devadatta is the standard example.
- Bhatta alone accepts anupalabdhi independently.
- Yogyata makes non-perception evidential.
- Trap: not seeing an imperceptible entity does not establish its absence.

Progress: 4 / 8 | Philosophy Layered Session | Subtopic: Self-Awareness and Error: Triputi, Jnatata and Two Mimamsa Theories

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Plain-language visual - how is knowing itself known?

PRABHAKARA: knower + object + cognition appear together
BHATTA: object's being-known points to the cognition
NYAYA: later reflection says "I know the object"

ILLUSION:
Prabhakara -> perception and memory not discriminated
Bhatta -> positive false synthesis under defect

In **simple words**: the two Mimamsa schools agree that cognition is trusted by default but disagree about how cognition becomes known and how illusion occurs.

Memory line: shared validity theory does not erase different accounts of awareness and error.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

6. SELF-AWARENESS AND ERROR

6.1 How do I know that I know?

School	How cognition is known	Core term
Prābhākara	cognition reveals knower, known and itself together	tripuṭī-samvit
Bhāṭṭa	cognition is inferred from the cognizedness of the object	jñātātā
Nyāya	a second-order reflective awareness takes the first cognition as its object	anuvyavasāya

6.2 Tripuṭī-samvit

FACT: In every cognition, Prābhākara says the triad is simultaneously given:

- **jñātr** - the knower,
- **jñeya** - the known object,
- **jñāna** - the cognition itself.

This blocks regress: if cognition were not manifest in the very act of knowing, another cognition would be needed to reveal it.

6.3 Jñātātā

FACT: Kumārila denies that cognition is self-luminous. What is directly secured is the object's state of **being-known**. From that cognizedness, a cognition is inferred.

ANALYSIS: This is the exact Bhāṭṭa proof that **intrinsic validity** does not logically require **self-luminosity**.

6.4 Error theory - akhyāti versus viparīta-khyāti

Issue	Prābhākara	Bhāṭṭa
Basic claim	no single false cognition is required	a genuinely false cognition occurs under defective conditions
Standard model	shell is perceived; silver is remembered; difference is not discriminated	shell is positively misapprehended as silver
Name	akhyāti / vivekākhyāti	viparīta-khyāti
Why it matters	protects truth of each constituent cognition	explains the assertive force of illusion more naturally

6.5 Cross-school comparison

School	Theory of error	Central idea
Prābhākara	akhyāti	non-discrimination between valid perception and valid memory
Bhāṭṭa	viparīta-khyāti	positive misapprehension caused by defect
Nyāya	anyathā-khyāti	a real object known elsewhere is misrelated here
Advaita	anirvacanīya-khyāti	the illusory object is neither fully real nor unreal

ANALYSIS: The 2022 twenty-marker turns on the paradox: **both sub-schools keep intrinsic validity, yet one minimizes falsity while the other allows error under extrinsic defect.**

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

Advanced anti-regress and assertiveness problems

Triputi-samvit directly blocks regress by making cognition manifest with knower and object. Nyaya gains analytic clarity through second-order awareness but must explain why reflection does not require endless reflection. Bhatta's *jnatata* preserves object-centred realism but may look like an extra posit.

Prabhakara's akhyati protects the truth of each constituent: present "this" perception and remembered silver. Error is failure to discriminate. Its weakness is the assertive force of "this is silver." Bhatta's viparita-khyati explains that force through a genuinely false synthesis caused by defects while retaining default validity under normal conditions.

The underlying methodological contrast is economy versus phenomenological adequacy: minimize false cognition or explain illusion as actually experienced.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Exam route

- **2022 Q7(a)**: explain why shared intrinsic validity permits divergent error theories.
- **2024 Q8(a)**: compare triputi-samvit, jnatata and Nyaya anuvyavasaya.
- Use shell-silver for both error accounts, but do not confuse Bhatta viparita-khyati with Nyaya anyatha-khyati.
- The Bhatta view proves intrinsic validity need not entail self-luminous cognition.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall

- Prabhakara: triputi-samvit and akhyati.
- Bhatta: jnatata and viparita-khyati.
- Nyaya: anuvyavasaya and anyatha-khyati.
- Akhyati means non-discrimination, not no cognition.
- Trap: error theory and validity theory answer different questions.

Progress: 5 / 8 | Philosophy Layered Session | Subtopic: Word Meaning, Sentence Meaning and Ritual Hermeneutics

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Plain-language visual - two routes from words to a sentence

BHATTA:

word 1 meaning + word 2 meaning + word 3 meaning
|
connection
v
sentence meaning

PRABHAKARA:

each word already conveys meaning-in-relation
|
v
sentence meaning directly

In simple words: Bhatta begins with stable lexical units and then composes them. Prabhakara begins with connected practical language-use.

Sentence condition	Meaning
Akanksa	Mutual expectancy
Yogyata	Semantic fitness

Sentence condition	Meaning
Sannidhi	Proper proximity

Memory line: one theory composes meanings; the other receives them already connected.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

7. ŚABDA, WORD-MEANING, SENTENCE-MEANING, AND RITUAL HERMENEUTICS

7.1 Why language matters so much

FACT: Mīmāṃsā is a school of **textual action-guidance**. It therefore asks not merely what words mean, but how a string of words becomes a binding unit of duty. The great question is **ekavākyatā** - sentence-unity.

7.2 Shared conditions of sentence unity

Condition	Meaning	Failure case
ākāṅkṣā	mutual expectancy among words	a verb with no completing object or subject
yogyatā	semantic fitness	impossible combination like “sprinkle with fire” in ordinary usage
sannidhi / āsatti	proper proximity or contiguity	words too far apart to belong to one sentence

ANALYSIS: Naiyāyikas often add **tātparya** as speaker's intention. Mīmāṃsā cannot ground the Veda in the psychology of a speaker, because the Veda is **apauruṣeya**.

7.3 Abhihitānvayavāda versus anvitābhīdhānavāda

Question	Bhāṭṭa answer	Prābhākara answer
What do words first convey?	isolated word-meanings	connected meanings already in relation
Sentence meaning arises how?	by connecting what words have already denoted	directly through words as context-bound conveyors
Usual label	abhihitānvayavāda	anvitābhīdhānavāda
Pedagogic intuition	lexical units first, then composition	practical sentence-use first, isolated meaning is derivative

FACT: Bhāṭṭa secures stable lexical meaning. FACT: Prābhākara secures contextual and action-guiding meaning. UPSC rewards answers that state both gains and both costs.

7.4 Do words refer to universals or particulars?

FACT: Mīmāṃsā generally gives semantic priority to **jāti** (universal), whereas Nyāya gives priority to the **qualified individual**. The dispute is not whether words can reach individuals at all, but **what explains repeatable meaning**.

Position	Why it chooses that priority
Mīmāṃsā	the same word applies across many individuals; universality explains repeatability
Nyāya	actual action concerns qualified individuals; universals function within that concrete referent

7.5 Ritual hermeneutics

FACT: Mīmāṃsā is also a theory of interpretation. The school develops ranked interpretive clues so that Vedic texts can be harmonized without collapse into arbitrariness.

Hermeneutic cue	Use
śruti	explicit statement
liṅga	indicative mark or clue
vākya	sentence-unity
prakaraṇa	larger context or topic
sthāna	placement
samākhyā	title or heading-name
utsarga / apavāda	general rule and exception

ANALYSIS: These are not decorative scholastic devices. They are the technical engine by which ritual duty is extracted from a large authorless corpus.

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

Advanced semantics without a speaker

Mimamsa cannot ground Vedic sentence-unity primarily in an author's intention because the Veda is authorless. It therefore develops textual and semantic conditions that operate without psychological authorship.

The Bhatta theory secures stable lexical meaning but must explain the additional compositional act. Prabhakara captures contextual and action-guiding unity but risks making isolated word meaning difficult to explain.

The universal-particular debate is separate. Mimamsa generally gives semantic priority to universals to explain repeatable use; Nyaya starts from the qualified individual to explain concrete action. Both can reach both levels but disagree about explanatory priority.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Exam route

- **2023 Q8(c):** compare universal-first Mimamsa with qualified-individual-first Nyaya.
- **2024 Q5(d):** distinguish abhihitavaya from anvaitabhidhana through lexical priority and sentence unity.
- Include akanksa, yogyata and sannidhi.
- Do not collapse sentence-composition theory into the universal-particular reference debate.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall

- Bhatta: abhihitavayavada.
- Prabhakara: anvaitabhidhanavada.
- Mimamsa usually prioritizes jati.
- Hermeneutic cues: sruti, linga, vakya, prakarana, sthana, samakhya.
- Trap: Vedic meaning cannot depend on a remembered human speaker.

Progress: 6 / 8 | Philosophy Layered Session | Subtopic: Authorless Veda, Anti-Theism, Karma and Later Moksa

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Plain-language visual - authority by removing the author

PERSONAL AUTHOR
can be ignorant, deceptive or partial
|
MIMAMSA EXCLUDES AUTHORSHIP
|
eternal word-meaning relation + unique access to dharma
|
VEDIC AUTHORITY

ritual action -> apurva -> fruit
No creator or fruit-dispenser God required.

In simple words: Nyaya protects scripture through a perfect author. Mimamsa protects it by denying that it has an author at all.

Memory line: exclude the source of authorial defect rather than perfect the author.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

8. APAURUṢEYATVA, VEDIC AUTHORITY, SELF, WORLD, GOD, KARMA, MOKṢA

8.1 Why Vedic authority matters

FACT: Perception shows visible things. Inference extends from marks to unobserved correlates. But **dharma** is neither visibly given nor inferable from ordinary worldly signs. Therefore **śabda**, especially Vedic śabda, becomes indispensable.

8.2 Apauruṣeyatva and śabda-nityatva

FACT: Mīmāṃsā defends the Veda as **authorless** and, in the relevant sense, **eternal**.

Main argumentative moves:

1. FACT: there is no remembered historical author of the Veda;
2. FACT: authorship would import the possibility of ignorance, deception or partiality;
3. FACT: word-meaning relation is treated as **autpattika** - natural or inherent, not newly set up by convention;
4. FACT: utterance manifests words rather than creating them anew;
5. FACT: therefore Vedic authority need not rest on a divine or human speaker.

Radhakrishnan's summary is especially useful: Mīmāṃsā protests against treating the Vedas as the work of God because a bodiless God has no organs of speech, and divine authorship would make Vedic authority depend on proving a person.

8.3 Why Nyāya and Mimamsa diverge over scripture

Issue	Mīmāṃsā	Nyāya
source of scriptural authority	authorless eternal Veda	omniscient reliable author (āpta), ultimately Īśvara
word-meaning relation	natural / inherent	conventional, instituted
preferred strategy	protect text by excluding author	protect text by perfecting author
Mimamsa objection	proving God's omniscience is harder than accepting authorlessness	authorlessness seems historically implausible

8.4 Self, world and karma

- FACT: The world is real.
- FACT: The self is enduring, not momentary.
- FACT: The self must persist as **knower, agent and enjoyer**; otherwise the performer of ritual could not be the receiver of its fruit.
- FACT: Karma requires continuity between deed and consequence.
- FACT: Apūrva is the unseen link between a perishing act and a delayed fruit.

8.5 God and anti-theism

FACT: Classical Pūrva-Mīmāṃsā rejects a **creator-God** and a **fruit-dispenser God**. This is not heterodoxy in the ordinary āstika sense, because orthodoxy here means fidelity to the Veda, not devotion to a creator.

Main anti-theistic reasons:

1. FACT: Veda does not need a divine author if it is apauruṣeya.
2. FACT: God would become a redundant extra alongside karma and apūrva.
3. FACT: If God dispenses according to karma, karma does the real work.
4. FACT: If God dispenses independently of karma, divine partiality appears.
5. FACT: The potter-world analogy proves too little: we observe pots made by embodied artisans, not worlds made by bodiless creators.

ANALYSIS: **Qualification:** ritual deities are not simply erased. They remain mantra-denoted entities inside sacrificial procedure, but they are not the sovereign producers of fruits.

8.6 Mokṣa in Mimamsa

CAUTION: Early Mīmāṃsā is more **svarga-oriented** than liberation-oriented. Later presentations, however, clearly describe mokṣa as cessation of pain, embodiment and karmic entanglement.

FACT: Sharma is explicit that later Mīmāṃsakas treat mokṣa negatively - as release from bondage and suffering rather than as Advaitic identity with Brahman. That caution is important: **do not Vedāntize Mīmāṃsā mokṣa**.

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

Advanced objective normativity without God

Apauruṣeyatva, word-eternity and an inherent word-meaning relation secure Vedic testimony in its special domain of supersensible duty. The strategy is anti-sceptical but historically and linguistically demanding: conventionalists challenge eternal language and natural semantic relations.

The school remains orthodox because orthodoxy means Vedic fidelity, not creator-theism. Karma and apurva explain fruit; God either becomes redundant if he follows karma or partial if he overrides it. Ritual deities remain procedure-bound rather than sovereign creators.

An enduring self is required to connect action and later experience. Later Mimamsa moksa is largely cessation of pain, embodiment and karmic entanglement; it should not be transformed into Advaitic Brahman-identity.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Exam route

- **2019 Q5(e)**: establish Vedic authority through authorlessness, word-eternity and unique access to dharma.
- Compare Mimamsa exclusion of author with Nyaya's omniscient author.
- For anti-theism, explain both redundancy and partiality dilemmas.
- Qualify moksa historically: early stress on dharma and heaven, later negative liberation.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall

- Veda is apauruseya and eternal in the relevant sense.
- Word-meaning relation is treated as natural.
- Creator and fruit-dispenser God are unnecessary.
- Self is enduring knower, agent and enjoyer.
- Trap: later moksa is not merger with Brahman.

Progress: 7 / 8 | Philosophy Layered Session | Subtopic: Comparisons, Criticisms, Traps and the Contemporary Sanskrit Context

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Plain-language visual - the main pressure points

NYAYA -> validity and special pramanas can be reduced externally
ADVAITA -> Veda also reveals accomplished reality, not only action
BUDDHISM -> eternal words, universals and enduring self are excessive
MIMAMSA -> default trust + textual rules + apurva preserve duty

In simple words: Mimamsa gains a powerful impersonal theory of normativity, but pays for it through eternal language, special pramanas, structured absences and unseen ritual potency.

Memory line: its achievement is normativity without divine command; its cost is a demanding hermeneutic ontology.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

9. MASTER COMPARISON GRID, CRITICISMS, AND UPSC TRAPS

9.1 Master comparison grid

Issue	Mīmāṃsā	Nyāya	Advaita Vedānta
validity	intrinsic	extrinsic / certification-heavy	knowledge valid until sublated within layered reality
special pramāṇas	arthāpatti; Bhāṭṭa adds anupalabdhi	reduces them where possible	often accepts six pramāṇas in later Advaita
cognition of cognition	tripuṭī-samvit or jñātātā	anuvyavasāya	self-luminous consciousness
Veda	authorless and eternal	reliable because of Īśvara	Upaniṣads reveal siddha-vastu
God	no creator or fruit-dispenser needed	theistic realism	empirical Īśvara, ultimate non-dual Brahman
mokṣa	later negative release from suffering and embodiment	release from pain	knowledge of identity of ātman and Brahman

9.2 Strong objections and the best Mimamsa replies

Objection	Best Mimamsa reply	Residual pressure
intrinsic validity licenses gullibility	default validity is defeasible and falsity is discovered later	critics ask whether this postpones rather than solves the problem
arthāpatti is hidden inference	explanatory compulsion is not the same as sign-based inference	Nyāya can still simulate many cases inferentially
anupalabdhi reifies negatives	determinate absence-cognition needs an object and a pramāṇa	ontological economy is sacrificed
sentence meaning needs a speaker's intention	Vedic purport is textual and rule-governed, not psychological	meaning without intending subject remains contested
authorless eternal language is implausible	authorlessness removes the whole class of authorial defects	conventionalist and Buddhist criticisms remain serious
karma needs an intelligent administrator	apūrva and beginningless order suffice	many still find unconscious potency obscure

9.3 High-value UPSC traps

1. ANALYSIS: **Prābhākara has five pramāṇas, not six.**
2. ANALYSIS: **Svataḥ-prāmāṇya is not infallibilism.**
3. ANALYSIS: **Bhāṭṭa can deny self-luminosity and still defend intrinsic validity.**
4. ANALYSIS: **Akhyāti means non-discrimination, not total absence of cognition.**
5. ANALYSIS: **Anupalabdhi is a Bhāṭṭa specialty.**
6. ANALYSIS: **Abhihitānvaya and anvītābhīdhāna are not the same debate as universal versus individual reference, though they interact.**
7. ANALYSIS: **Mīmāṃsā does not prove Veda through God; it secures Veda by excluding God as author.**
8. ANALYSIS: **Mokṣa in Mīmāṃsā is not merger into Brahman.**
9. ANALYSIS: **Apūrva is the link between act and fruit; it is not identical with God, fate or visible physical causation.**
10. ANALYSIS: **Bhāvanā-vāda and niyoga-vāda must be kept distinct.**

10. CONTEMPORARY LINKAGE - CENTRAL SANSKRIT UNIVERSITY, 2026-27

FACT: Verified official anchor: the Central Sanskrit University page for **Central Schemes - Online Application Forms** states that online applications are invited for financial assistance for the year **2026-27** under “**Schemes for Sanskrit Promotion.**” The page lists Sanskrit teaching support, programmes and activities, publication and reprint of Sanskrit books, Shāstra Chudamani, scholarships in Sanskrit/Pali/Prakrit, vocational courses, and Ashtādashī projects. The same official CSU portal was identified by web search as carrying the formal English notification dated **01/04/2026**.

ANALYSIS: Why this is a legitimate Mimamsa linkage: it does **not** prove Mīmāṃsā doctrine and should never be presented as evidence for apauruṣeyatva, svataḥ-prāmāṇya or ritual efficacy. It is relevant only because Mīmāṃsā lives in a world of Sanskrit textual transmission, publication, teaching, commentary, and interpretive training. A modern state-supported Sanskrit ecosystem keeps alive the language-and-text conditions within which Vedic hermeneutics remains publicly meaningful.

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

Advanced critical balance

Intrinsic validity avoids regress and explains ordinary epistemic confidence, but critics ask whether default authority merely postpones certification. Arthapatti captures explanatory compulsion, yet Nyaya can often simulate it inferentially. Anupalabdhi preserves negative judgments at the cost of a new pramana and richer ontology.

Authorless language removes authorial defect but leaves the problem of how meaning and normativity arise without intention. Apurva links act and fruit but can look like a theoretical placeholder replacing divine administration.

The official 2026-27 Central Sanskrit University programmes and Sanskrit-promotion schemes provide a legitimate educational linkage: they sustain shastra teaching, publication and interpretive training. They do not prove classical doctrines such as authorlessness or ritual efficacy.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Exam route

Use a four-column structure: **objection -> Mimamsa reply -> gain -> residual pressure.**

High-risk checks:

1. Prabhakara has five pramanas.
2. Intrinsic validity is defeasible.
3. Anupalabdhi belongs independently to Bhatta.
4. Mimamsa secures Veda without God.
5. Apurva is neither fate nor God in disguise.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall

- Strongest achievement: knowledge and language grounding impersonal duty.
- Main costs: eternal words, apurva, absence ontology and special pramanas.
- CSU 2026-27 is educational context only.
- Best verdict: internally coherent, externally dependent on contested semantic and ritual assumptions.

Progress: 8 / 8 | Philosophy Layered Session | Subtopic: PYQ Routing, Answer Architecture and Complete Exam Deployment

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Plain-language visual - route the question before writing

QUESTION

```
|
+-- validity / memory
+-- arthapatti / anupalabdhi
+-- self-awareness / error
+-- word and sentence meaning
+-- Vedic authority / God
|
```

technical distinction -> example -> rival -> verdict

In simple words: the 14 verified questions repeatedly test internal Bhatta-Prabhakara differences and contrasts with Nyaya or Advaita. Precision in sub-school attribution is essential.

Marks	Minimum architecture
10	Definition -> example -> contrast -> verdict

Marks	Minimum architecture
15	Problem -> mechanism -> objection/reply -> assessment
20	Full distinction -> both sub-schools -> rival comparison -> judgement

Memory line: attribute first, compare second, evaluate third.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

11. PYQ ROUTING (2018-2025)

ANALYSIS: Corpus signal: 14 primary-owned question-parts out of 112 in the verified Indian Philosophy bank. Mimamsa appears in every year from 2018 through 2025.

Year	Question	Marks	Exact demand
2018	Q8(a)	20 marks	Does the admission of Svayaṃprakāśavāda necessarily lead to the admission of Svataḥprāmāṇyavāda? Discuss after the Naiyāyikas, the Mīmāṃsakas and the Advaita Vedāntins.
2019	Q5(e)	10 marks	How does Mīmāṃsā establish the authority of Vedic knowledge?
2020	Q5(c)	10 marks	Why is memory not a valid knowledge according to Mīmāṃsā?
2021	Q6(c)	15 marks	What, according to Mīmāṃsakas, is the ontological status of abhāva (absence) and how does one know it? Explain and examine.
2022	Q6(c)	15 marks	How do Mīmāṃsakas refute the Nyāya view that Implication (arthāpatti) is reducible to Inference (anumāna) and establish Implication as an independent means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)? Critically discuss.
2022	Q7(a)	20 marks	In spite of accepting the intrinsic validity of knowledge, why and how Prabhākara and Kumārila differ in their interpretation of erroneous cognition? Discuss.
2023	Q6(b)	15 marks	Present Bhaṭṭa's view of anupalabdhi (non-cognition) as a valid means of knowledge.
2023	Q8(c)	15 marks	Do words refer to universals or particulars or both? Present an exposition of Nyāya and Mīmāṃsā position with regard to above question along with suitable examples.
2024	Q5(d)	10 marks	How does Bhaṭṭa's view of nature of word-meaning and sentential-meaning differ from Prabhākara's view? Critically discuss.
2024	Q8(a)	20 marks	How do I know that I know? Answer this question with reference to the Naiyāyikas, the Bhaṭṭa Mīmāṃsakas and the Prābhākaras.
2024	Q8(b)	15 marks	"A candidate who is never seen to be studying during the day time secures a high position in a competitive exam." How would the Bhaṭṭa Mīmāṃsakas and the Naiyāyikas explain the success of this candidate? Discuss.
2024	Q8(c)	15 marks	On what grounds do the Prābhākaras and the Naiyāyikas reject memory as a source of knowledge? Discuss.
2025	Q5(c)	10 marks	Delineate the main points of difference between the theory of intrinsic validation (svataḥ prāmāṇyavāda) and theory of extrinsic validation (parataḥ prāmāṇyavāda) in classical Indian philosophy.
2025	Q6(c)	15 marks	Discuss the debate between the Bhaṭṭa and the Prabhākara mīmāṃsakas with reference to the nature of Non-existence (Abhāva) and its knowledge.

12. ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

12.1 Ten-marker (10 marks)

Define the doctrine exactly.
State the standard example.
Give the sub-school or rival-school contrast.
Add one criticism or limitation.
Close with one direct evaluative line.

12.2 Fifteen-marker (15 marks)

Frame the problem.
Explain the mechanism in ordered steps.
Use one example and one comparison.
Add one objection and one reply.
Conclude with a reasoned verdict.

12.3 Twenty-marker (20 marks)

Open with the conceptual issue, not only a definition.
Reconstruct the doctrine in full.
Bring in both Bhāṭṭa and Prābhākara where relevant.
Compare with Nyāya and/or Advaita.
State the deepest criticism and the best Mīmāṃsā reply.
End with a graded judgement.

13. SOURCES AND LOCAL EVIDENCE

- FACT: Canonical owner read end-to-end:
upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Philosophy\paper-1\indian\Mimamsa.md.
- FACT: Verified question wording and routing controlled by:
upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Philosophy\paper-1_PYQ-Indian-Philosophy-2018-2025.md.
- FACT: Chatterjee and Datta, **Chapter IX - The Mimamsa Philosophy**, local OCR-searchable PDF
books\philosophy_books\Chatterjeedatta_introductionToIndianPhilosophy.pdf, especially file
pages **379-409** for the two-fold role of Mīmāṃsā, the list of pramāṇas, arthāpatti, Vedic authorlessness and the
non-creator stance.
- FACT: C.D. Sharma, **Purva-Mimamsa** discussion in
books\philosophy_books\Indian-Philosophy-A-Critical-Survey.pdf, especially searchable file
pages around **203** and **233-236** for arthāpatti, jñātātā, later mokṣa doctrine and Kumārila's historical role.
- FACT: Radhakrishnan, **The Purva Mimamsa** chapter in books\philosophy_books\Indian Philosophy
Vol. 2 by Radhakrishnan.pdf, especially file pages **383-414** for pramāṇas, tripuṭi-samvit, jñātātā, Veda,
and anti-theistic argument.
- FACT: Official contemporary linkage verified through
https://sanskrit.nic.in/schemes/central_schemes_forms.php and the associated CSU notification
identified by web search on the same official portal.

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

Advanced corpus strategy

Mimamsa appears in every year from 2018 through 2025. The recurrence is structured rather than random: validity, memory, arthapatti, absence, self-awareness, error, semantics and Vedic authority form reusable modules.

Master one example for each module—Devadatta, empty table, shell-silver, "cow", and Vedic injunction. Then attach the correct sub-school, rival reduction and residual difficulty.

The final register notes should be used after solving practice. They preserve the integrated chain from validity and language to duty and apurva rather than replacing the arguments.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Exam route

The complete practice section contains:

- **14 verified solved PYQs** from 2018-2025.
- **32 original MCQs** with strict A-B-C-D rotation.
- Remedial error-correction drills.
- Original 10-, 15- and 20-mark questions with model solutions.
- Final consolidated register notes after all teaching and practice.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall - master route

Prompt	Recall spine
Dharma	injunction -> action -> apurva -> fruit
Validity	intrinsic authority, extrinsic defeat
Arthapatti	explanatory incompatibility
Absence	yogyata and Bhatta anupalabdhī
Awareness	triputi vs jñatata vs anuvyavasaya
Error	akhyati vs viparita-khyati
Semantics	abhihitānvaya vs anvītabhidhāna
Veda	authorless authority without creator God

PART II - COMPLETE SOLVED PRACTICE

Learning Design and Retrieval Map

This package follows the doctrinal chain that actually organizes the topic:

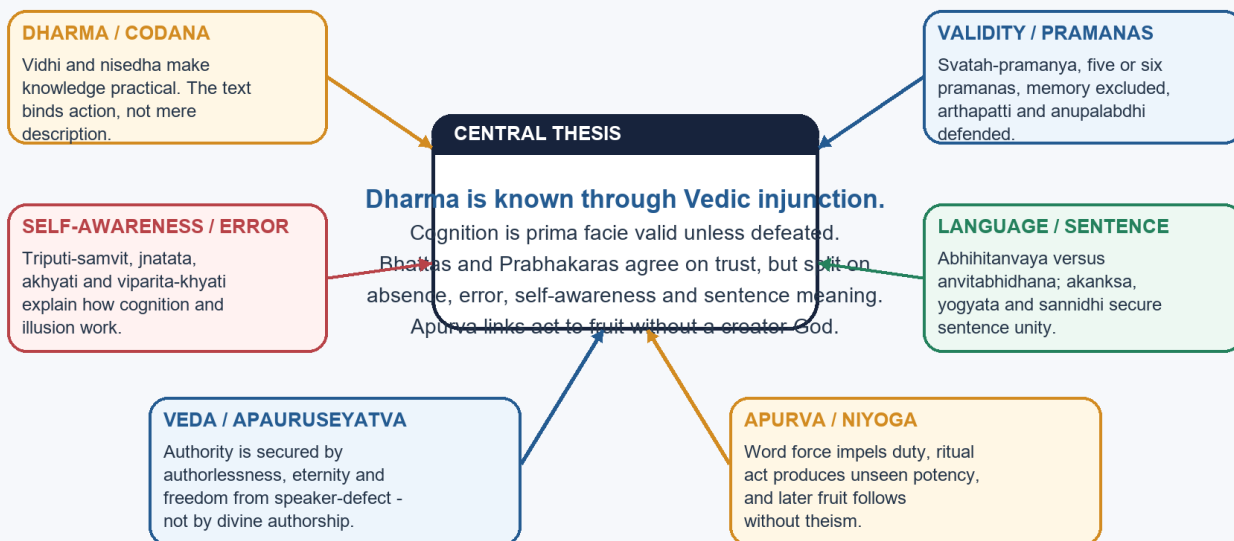
```
DHARMA KNOWN THROUGH VEDIC INJUNCTION
|
v
DEFAULT TRUST IN COGNITION
|
v
SPECIAL PRAMANAS FOR WHAT INFERENCE OR PERCEPTION CANNOT EXHAUST
|
+--> arthapatti -> explanatory supplementation
+--> anupalabdhī -> determinate absence
+--> śabda -> supersensible duty
|
v
LANGUAGE + HERMENEUTICS + ACTION
|
v
APURVA, KARMA, DUTY, AND LATER MOKSA
```

Master distinction: Mīmāṃsā is strongest when read as a theory of **knowledge in the service of duty**. If you separate pramāṇa theory from injunction, Vedic authority, language and apurva, the system starts looking like a disconnected list of doctrines.

Visual - Hermeneutic Knowledge Map

MIMAMSA: KNOWLEDGE IN DEFENCE OF DHARMA

Validity, language, injunction, absence, error and apurva in one exam map



SPINE: default trust -> special pramāṇas -> language and injunction -> apurva -> criticism and graded validity

Mimamsa: knowledge in defence of dharma

The same map should be mentally reused in answers: validity -> pramāṇa -> language -> injunction -> apurva -> criticism.

Rapid Retrieval Matrix

Prompt	One-line recall spine
Orientation	inquiry into dharma through Vedic injunction
Validity	intrinsic validity, extrinsic invalidity
Pramāṇas	5 Prābhākara / 6 Bhāṭṭa
Memory	not pramāṇa because no novelty
Arthāpatti	explanatory compulsion, Devadatta case
Anupalabdhi	non-perception of what would be perceived if present
Self-awareness	tripuṭī-samvit vs jñātata vs anuvyavasāya
Error	akhyāti vs viparīta-khyāti
Semantics	abhihitānvaya vs anvītābhīdhāna
Veda	apauruṣeya, eternal, self-valid for dharma
Anti-theism	karma and apurva make creator-God redundant
Mokṣa	later negative release, not Brahman-identity

SOLVED PYQ WORKBOOK - ALL 14 VERIFIED QUESTIONS

Solved PYQ 1 - 2018 Q8(a), 20 marks

Question: Does the admission of Svayaṃprakāśavāda necessarily lead to the admission of Svataḥprāmāṇyavāda? Discuss after the Naiyāyikas, the Mīmāṃsakas and the Advaita Vedāntins.

Model solution

The relation is close but **not logically necessary**. **Svayaṃprakāśavāda** concerns how cognition or consciousness becomes manifest; **svataḥ-prāmāṇyavāda** concerns whether cognition carries its own prima facie validity. Manifestation and validity therefore address two different questions.

The **Naiyāyikas** deny both theses. A cognition is known through a later **anuvyavasāya**, and its validity is established extrinsically through correspondence, successful action or later confirmation. For Nyāya, immediate appearance does not yet amount to certified truth.

Among the **Mīmāṃsakas**, the issue divides sharply. **Prābhākara** supports a strong form of self-revelation through **tripuṭi-samvit**: knower, known and knowledge appear together. He also supports intrinsic validity, because another validating cognition would generate regress. Here self-luminosity and intrinsic validity travel together.

But **Kumārila Bhaṭṭa** breaks any claim of necessity. He too accepts intrinsic validity: cognition is trusted unless defeated by later contradiction or defect-awareness. Yet he denies that cognition is self-luminous. Cognition is known through the object's **jñātātā** or cognizedness. Thus one may defend svataḥ-prāmāṇya without accepting svayaṃprakāśa.

Advaita Vedānta complicates the issue further. Advaita strongly affirms self-luminous consciousness, but its final subject is not merely episodic cognition; it is consciousness as such, ultimately ātman-Brahman. Empirical cognitions function as valid until sublated, but Advaita's deepest self-luminosity thesis is metaphysical rather than merely epistemic. Hence the inference from self-revelation to intrinsic validity still requires argument.

School	Self-luminosity?	Intrinsic validity?	Result
Nyāya	No	No	both denied
Prābhākara Mīmāṃsā	Yes	Yes	close linkage
Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā	No	Yes	decisive counterexample to necessity
Advaita	Yes, at the level of consciousness itself	broad presumption of validity until sublation	related, but not a simple entailment

Conclusion: self-luminosity may support intrinsic validity, but it does not necessarily entail it. The Bhāṭṭa position proves that a thinker may deny self-luminosity and still defend intrinsic validity; therefore the two doctrines must be kept conceptually distinct.

Why this earns marks: It separates manifestation from validity, compares all three requested schools, and uses the Bhāṭṭa position as the decisive argument against any claim of strict entailment.

Solved PYQ 2 - 2019 Q5(e), 10 marks

Question: How does Mīmāṃsā establish the authority of Vedic knowledge?

Model solution

Mīmāṃsā establishes Vedic authority through **apauruṣeyatva**, **śabda-nityatva**, and the special domain of **dharma**. The Veda is authoritative because it is **authorless**, eternal and therefore free from the defects that affect personal testimony - ignorance, deception, forgetfulness or partiality. A human or divine author would introduce precisely the kind of locus of error that Mīmāṃsā wants to exclude.

The school also treats the relation between word and meaning as **autpattika**, natural or inherent, not a convention imposed by an institutor. Words are manifested in utterance rather than created anew. Hence the Veda does not depend for its authority on a historical act of composition.

Most importantly, the Veda has a unique object: **dharma**, which is supersensible. Perception and inference can tell us about ordinary worldly objects, but not about ritual duty and unseen fruit. Therefore Vedic testimony is indispensable in its own sphere. Testimony of a reliable person may also yield knowledge, but Vedic knowledge has a superior status because its object cannot be known otherwise.

Nyāya tries to secure scripture through God as an omniscient author. Mīmāṃsā rejects this as unnecessary and weaker: one would first have to prove God's existence, omniscience and sincerity. Authorlessness is thus the school's stronger route.

Why this earns marks: It states the three core supports - *apauruṣeyatva*, eternity and unique revelatory scope - and directly contrasts the Mimamsa strategy with Nyāya's God-author model.

Solved PYQ 3 - 2020 Q5(c), 10 marks

Question: Why is memory not a valid knowledge according to Mīmāṃsā?

Model solution

Mīmāṃsā denies *pramāṇa*-status to memory because memory does **not** generate a previously unknown cognition. A valid means of knowledge must disclose an object with novelty and present epistemic force. Memory depends on an earlier cognition and a residual impression; it merely reproduces what has already been known.

This is why recollection is different from perception or inference. Perception reveals an object directly here and now. Inference yields a fresh mediate cognition. Memory, by contrast, only re-presents past content. It may be true, useful and practically important, but its truth is derivative from the original cognition on which it rests.

Both **Prābhākara** and **Nyāya** agree on this point. The dependence of memory on prior apprehension is exactly what disqualifies it from being a fresh source of valid knowledge.

Conclusion: memory is not false simply because it is memory; it is excluded because it lacks the novelty required of a *pramāṇa*.

Why this earns marks: It gives the exact exclusion criterion, distinguishes memory from fresh cognition, and avoids the trap of treating memory as false rather than merely non-*pramāṇic*.

Solved PYQ 4 - 2021 Q6(c), 15 marks

Question: What, according to Mīmāṃsakas, is the ontological status of *abhāva* (absence) and how does one know it? Explain and examine.

Model solution

For the **Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsakas**, *abhāva* is real enough to be the object of determinate cognition. When I say, "there is no jar on the floor," I am not merely ignorant of a jar; I positively know its absence. That cognition is structured by a **pratiyogin**, the counterpositive whose absence is at issue.

Bhāṭṭa therefore accepts **anupalabdhi** as an independent *pramāṇa*. The classic formula is: absence is known through **non-apprehension of what would be apprehended if present**. This requires **yogyānupalabdhi** - fitness conditions such as proper light, functioning sense-organ, available locus and appropriate attention. Only then does non-perception disclose absence.

Prābhākara resists a separate *anupalabdhi*. He explains the case as perception of the bare locus unqualified by the absent object. **Nyāya** also rejects an independent *anupalabdhi*, though it accepts absence as ontologically significant and handles it through perception or inference.

View	Status of <i>abhāva</i>	How known?
Bhāṭṭa	real negative entity/content	<i>anupalabdhi</i>
Prābhākara	not denied, but no new <i>pramāṇa</i> required	bare-locus cognition
Nyāya	real category	perception or inference, not separate <i>anupalabdhi</i>

Examination: Bhāṭṭa preserves the determinacy of negative cognition very well, but at the price of both a richer ontology and a new *pramāṇa*. Prābhākara is more economical, but critics ask whether "bare locus" really explains the

judgment “the jar is absent.”

Verdict: the Bhāṭṭa account is stronger if one wants to preserve the full objecthood of absence; the Prābhākara account is stronger if one prioritizes ontological and epistemic economy.

Why this earns marks: It presents both the ontological and epistemic sides of the issue, gives the fitness condition for absence-knowledge, and ends with a balanced evaluative comparison.

Solved PYQ 5 - 2022 Q6(c), 15 marks

Question: How do Mīmāṃsakas refute the Nyāya view that Implication (arthāpatti) is reducible to Inference (anumāna) and establish Implication as an independent means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)? Critically discuss.

Model solution

Mīmāṃsā treats **arthāpatti** as a distinct pramāṇa because it arises from **explanatory compulsion**, not from the sign-based structure of inference. The standard case is: “Devadatta is stout, and Devadatta does not eat during the day.” To preserve both accepted facts, one must postulate that Devadatta eats at night.

The Nyāya reduction attempts to turn this into inference:

- all stout persons who do not eat by day eat by night;
- Devadatta is stout and does not eat by day;
- therefore Devadatta eats by night.

Mīmāṃsā objects on three grounds. First, the alleged **vyāpti** is not independently known; it is abstracted from the very explanatory tension that arthāpatti is supposed to solve. Second, inference moves from **hetu** to **sādhya**, whereas arthāpatti moves from **incompatible accepted facts** to a postulate that alone makes them coherent. Third, the arthāpatti case lacks the normal **pakṣa-hetu-sādhya** structure.

Kumārila therefore insists that arthāpatti is not a weak guess or provisional hypothesis. It yields the one fact without which the data remain untenable. Chatterjee and Datta put the point sharply: a hypothesis remains tentative, but arthāpatti carries conviction as the only viable explanation.

Critical discussion: Nyāya can often reconstruct such cases inferentially, and that is why the debate survives. But the Mimamsa claim is that the inferential reconstruction is parasitic on a prior recognition of explanatory incompatibility. If that is right, arthāpatti deserves independent status.

Verdict: arthāpatti is best defended as the epistemic form of explanatory necessity; whether one grants it full independence depends on whether one thinks inferential reformulation captures or merely redescribes that necessity.

Why this earns marks: It states the Nyāya reduction fairly, gives the three standard Mimamsa objections, uses the Devadatta case correctly, and ends with a qualified critical verdict.

Solved PYQ 6 - 2022 Q7(a), 20 marks

Question: In spite of accepting the intrinsic validity of knowledge, why and how Prabhākara and Kumārila differ in their interpretation of erroneous cognition? Discuss.

Model solution

Both Prabhākara and Kumārila accept **svataḥ-prāmāṇya**: cognition is prima facie valid and does not need prior external certification. Yet they diverge because they explain error in different ways.

For **Prabhākara**, the central issue is to preserve the truth of each constituent cognition. In shell-silver illusion, the present shining object is genuinely perceived as “this,” while previously seen silver is genuinely remembered. The error lies in **non-discrimination** between these two valid cognitions. This is **akhyāti** or, more precisely, **vivekākhyāti** - failure to apprehend the difference. No single false cognition needs to be posited.

For **Kumārila**, this is too weak to explain the assertive force of illusion. The subject does not merely have a perception plus a memory; the subject really judges, “this is silver.” Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā therefore accepts a positive misapprehension, **viparīta-khyāti**. A false cognition occurs, but only under defective conditions - poor light, similarity, distance or other causal disturbance. Intrinsic validity is preserved because falsity is not basic; it is **extrinsically occasioned** and later disclosed through correction.

Issue	Prabhākara	Kumārila
Status of constituents	both perception and memory remain valid	a false synthetic cognition occurs
Name of theory	akhyāti / vivekākhyāti	viparīta-khyāti
Strategy for saving intrinsic validity	error lies in non-discrimination, not false cognition	normal cognition remains self-valid; error belongs to defective conditions
Strength	strong anti-skeptical economy	better explanation of the lived assertiveness of illusion
Weakness	seems too weak for “this is silver”	admits real falsity and must explain how default validity survives

Nyāya and Advaita help sharpen the point. Nyāya's **anyathākhyāti** relocates the real silver elsewhere; Advaita's **anirvacanīya-khyāti** treats the illusory object as neither real nor unreal. By contrast, both Mimamsa sub-schools remain broadly realist and anti-skeptical.

Conclusion: the disagreement does not cancel intrinsic validity. It shows two different ways of protecting it - Prabhākara by minimizing falsity, Kumārila by localizing falsity in defect-ridden conditions.

Why this earns marks: It explains why the paradox arises, reconstructs both theories through the shell-silver case, compares their strengths and weaknesses, and ties the whole debate back to intrinsic validity.

Solved PYQ 7 - 2023 Q6(b), 15 marks

Question: Present Bhaṭṭa's view of anupalabdhi (non-cognition) as a valid means of knowledge.

Model solution

Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā accepts **anupalabdhi** as an independent pramāṇa because determinate absence-cognition cannot, in its view, be reduced either to perception or to inference. When I judge, “the jar is not on the floor,” I do not merely fail to see a jar; I positively know its absence.

The key formula is **yogyānupalabdhi**: non-apprehension of an object that **would** be apprehended if it were present. Four features matter - perceptibility of the object, availability of the locus, functioning sense-organ, and fit conditions such as light and attention. Under these conditions, non-perception becomes cognitively significant.

Bhāṭṭa denies reduction to perception because perception requires contact with a present object. Absence is not a positive sensible object in that way. He denies reduction to inference because the evidentiary force of not-seeing the jar already presupposes the principle that non-apprehension under fit conditions reveals absence; inferential reduction thus becomes circular.

Claim	Bhāṭṭa position
What is known?	a real absence with a counterpositive
How known?	by an independent pramāṇa, anupalabdhi
Limiting condition	only under yogyatā / fitness
Why not perception?	no present positive object is contacted
Why not inference?	inferential force already presupposes anupalabdhi

Critical note: the theory preserves ordinary negative judgments very well, but it multiplies both ontology and pramāṇas. This is why Prabhākara and Nyāya resist it.

Verdict: Bhaṭṭa's anupalabdhi is strongest when one insists that absence-cognition is both determinate and irreducible.

Why this earns marks: It states the exact defining formula, explains the fitness condition, answers both reduction attempts, and ends with the standard critical qualification.

Solved PYQ 8 - 2023 Q8(c), 15 marks

Question: Do words refer to universals or particulars or both? Present an exposition of Nyāya and Mīmāṃsā position with regard to above question along with suitable examples.

Model solution

The dispute is not over whether language can finally guide us to individuals; it is over **semantic priority**. **Mīmāṃsā** generally holds that words primarily denote **universals (jāti)**, while **Nyāya** gives priority to the **qualified individual (vyakti)**.

Mīmāṃsā argues that one and the same word - for example, "cow" - applies across many individual cows. This repeatability is best explained if the word first denotes **cow-ness**. In a concrete context, the universal becomes instantiated in this or that cow, and action then concerns the qualified individual. The school therefore preserves practical reference without surrendering universal meaning.

Nyāya reverses the order. A word refers to an individual that is qualified by universal, form and relational features. This better suits action-language. One milks or brings **this cow**, not a bare universal. The universal is not denied, but it is not the primary referent.

Issue	Mīmāṃsā	Nyāya
Primary denotation	jāti / universal	qualified individual
Main reason	explains repeatable use across many cases	explains concrete action and reference
What is not denied	contextual reach to individuals	role of universals in cognition

Example: in a Vedic sentence about sacrifice, Mīmāṃsā can say the word first conveys the class-character needed for repeatable rule-application; Nyāya insists that actual ritual performance requires a determinate qualified individual.

Conclusion: both schools can reach both universal and individual, but they differ on where semantic explanation should begin. Mīmāṃsā starts from repeatability; Nyāya starts from concrete qualified reference.

Why this earns marks: It gives both positions without caricature, explains the idea of semantic priority, and uses examples that connect ordinary language with ritual application.

Solved PYQ 9 - 2024 Q5(d), 10 marks

Question: How does Bhāṭṭa's view of nature of word-meaning and sentential-meaning differ from Prabhākara's view? Critically discuss.

Model solution

The difference is captured by the two classic labels **abhihitānvayavāda** and **anvitābhīdhānavāda**.

For **Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā**, words first denote their own separate meanings. Sentence-meaning arises later by connecting those already-denoted meanings. Hence the word is the primary semantic unit and the sentence is compositional.

For **Prābhākara**, words do not first present isolated meanings. They signify meanings only as **already connected** within a sentence. The sentence is primary, and isolated lexical meaning is an abstraction from living use.

Issue	Bhāṭṭa	Prābhākara
Theory name	abhihitānvayavāda	anvitābhīdhānavāda
First semantic unit	word	connected sentence-use
Strength	preserves stable lexical meaning	preserves contextual and action-guiding meaning
Main criticism	requires an additional connecting step	risks making isolated word-meaning too dependent on context

Both accept **ākāṅkṣā**, **yogyatā** and **sannidhi** as conditions of sentence-unity. The critical issue is whether sentence meaning is built from prior word-meanings or directly grasped as connected.

Verdict: Bhāṭṭa is stronger on compositional stability; Prābhākara is stronger on lived contextual comprehension.

Why this earns marks: It states both technical terms correctly, gives the difference in one clean table, and ends with a real critical contrast instead of mere paraphrase.

Solved PYQ 10 - 2024 Q8(a), 20 marks

Question: How do I know that I know? Answer this question with reference to the Naiyāyikas, the Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsakas and the Prābhākara.

Model solution

The problem is reflexive awareness: once an object is known, how is the **cognition itself** known? Nyāya, Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā and Prābhākara offer three distinct answers.

Prābhākara accepts **tripuṭī-samvit**. In every cognition, three things are simultaneously revealed: the knower, the known and the cognition. Awareness is self-manifest in the very act of presenting the object. This blocks regress: if cognition required another cognition to reveal it, an infinite chain would follow.

Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā denies that cognition is self-luminous. What becomes directly available is the object's **jñātātā** or cognizedness - its being-known. From that state one infers that a cognition has occurred. Reflexive awareness is therefore mediated, not immediate.

Nyāya rejects both self-luminosity and jñātātā-inference as the final account. It explains metacognition through **anuvyavasāya**, a higher-order cognition that takes the first cognition as its object. I first know the pot, and then I have a second cognition of the form "I know the pot."

School	First-order cognition	How second-order awareness arises	Main advantage	Main difficulty
Prābhākara	object, self and cognition appear together	immediate self-revelation	anti-regress and phenomenological economy	critics say the triad is packed too tightly
Bhāṭṭa	object is known; cognition leaves cognizedness in the object	cognition inferred from jñātātā	preserves object-realism and avoids self-luminous episodes	critics call jñātātā an unnecessary extra entity
Nyāya	object is known in the first act	anuvyavasāya reflects on that act	clear distinction between object-knowledge and metacognition	critics say regress pressure is only postponed

A good comparison also shows what each school fears most. Prābhākara fears regress, Bhāṭṭa fears collapse into self-luminous idealism or unnecessary subjectivism, and Nyāya fears making every cognition self-certifying.

Conclusion: the three schools answer the same question by privileging different epistemic goods - immediacy, mediated realism and reflective structure. The sharpest Mimamsa insight is that cognition cannot be both necessary for all knowing and completely invisible to itself.

Why this earns marks: It covers all three requested schools in a structured comparison, uses the exact technical terms, and explains the philosophical motivation behind each account instead of merely naming them.

Solved PYQ 11 - 2024 Q8(b), 15 marks

Question: "A candidate who is never seen to be studying during the day time secures a high position in a competitive exam." How would the Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsakas and the Naiyāyikas explain the success of this candidate? Discuss.

Model solution

The example is a modernized **arthāpatti** case. The **Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsaka** begins with two accepted facts: the candidate is never seen studying in the daytime, and yet secures a high rank. These facts are not jointly intelligible unless some unobserved preparation is postulated. Therefore the candidate must be studying at night, very early morning, or in another unobserved period. The knowledge is not inferential in the ordinary sense; it is a compelled explanatory postulation.

The **Naiyāyika** attempts to restate the case as an inference. Success in a competitive examination is regularly connected with adequate preparation. This candidate is successful. Therefore this candidate must have prepared. The unobserved preparation is established inferentially from a known relation between success and study.

School	Logical movement	Strength	Weakness
Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā	incompatible accepted facts -> necessary postulate	captures the “must be so” force of the case	critics say it can be re-described as inference
Nyāya	known relation -> inferential conclusion	keeps one unified theory of mediate knowledge	critics say the explanatory tension is being hidden inside the universal premise

Discussion: the Bhāṭṭa claims that the Naiyāyika universal is not independently available; it is extracted from the very explanatory need at issue. Nyāya replies that once the relation between success and preparation is allowed, inference is enough.

Verdict: the case is philosophically useful precisely because it sits at the boundary between postulation and inference; Bhāṭṭa says that boundary is real, Nyāya says it is reducible.

Why this earns marks: It recognizes the example as a modern arthāpatti test-case, presents both explanations fairly, and explains why the dispute survives instead of giving a one-line winner.

Solved PYQ 12 - 2024 Q8(c), 15 marks

Question: On what grounds do the Prābhākaras and the Naiyāyikas reject memory as a source of knowledge? Discuss.

Model solution

Both Prābhākaras and Naiyāyikas reject memory as a pramāṇa because memory lacks the **novel presentational force** that belongs to genuine means of knowledge. It depends on a prior cognition and a residual mental trace.

For the **Prābhākaras**, a pramāṇa must produce fresh cognition of an object. Memory simply reproduces what has already been known. It does not disclose an object as presently given; rather, it recalls what was previously apprehended. Its dependence on earlier knowledge is therefore intrinsic to its non-pramāṇic character.

The **Naiyāyikas** reach a similar conclusion from a different angle. Valid cognition must arise from the proper operation of a pramāṇa such as perception, inference, comparison or testimony. Memory does not arise from present contact with an object, a current inferential mark, a live comparison or a fresh utterance. It arises from a **saṃskāra** left by earlier cognition. Therefore it may be true, but it is not knowledge newly generated by a pramāṇa.

Ground of rejection	Prābhākara emphasis	Nyāya emphasis
lack of novelty	decisive	decisive
dependence on prior cognition	explicit criterion	implicit through saṃskāra theory
present disclosure	absent	absent
truth-value	memory may be true	memory may be true

Conclusion: both schools reject memory not because it is false, but because it is derivative and non-originate. The shared criterion is novelty; the main difference lies in the wider epistemological systems in which that criterion is embedded.

Why this earns marks: It answers the exact “grounds” asked for, gives both schools separately, and avoids the common mistake of calling memory invalid simply because it looks backward.

Solved PYQ 13 - 2025 Q5(c), 10 marks

Question: Delineate the main points of difference between the theory of intrinsic validation (svataḥ prāmāṇyavāda) and theory of extrinsic validation (parataḥ prāmāṇyavāda) in classical Indian philosophy.

Model solution

The difference concerns both the **source** of validity and the **way** validity becomes known.

In **svataḥ-prāmāṇyavāda**, defended classically by Mīmāṃsā, cognition is valid by its own occurrence under normal conditions. It presents itself as trustworthy and is acted upon unless defeated by later contradiction or discovery of defect. Invalidity is therefore extrinsic and subsequent.

In **parataḥ-prāmāṇyavāda**, associated in the standard contrast with Nyāya, the mere occurrence of cognition does not suffice for its validation. Truth is secured through something outside the cognition itself - successful action, later confirming cognition, or reflective assessment.

Issue	Svataḥ-prāmāṇya	Parataḥ-prāmāṇya
initial status	prima facie valid	not fully validated by bare occurrence
need for external certificate	no	yes
invalidity	discovered through later defect or contradiction	built into validation process through external checks
strongest Mimamsa argument	avoids infinite regress and matches practical life	Nyāya says this leaves cognition under-verified
strongest Nyāya concern	Mimamsa says it risks regress and hidden prior trust	avoids gullibility and demands verification

Conclusion: the first begins with trust and allows correction later; the second begins with the need for validation and risks regress unless it can explain how validating cognition itself becomes acceptable.

Why this earns marks: It delineates the doctrine on exactly the requested axis, uses the standard school contrast, and states the decisive strength of each side in one compact answer.

Solved PYQ 14 - 2025 Q6(c), 15 marks

Question: Discuss the debate between the Bhāṭṭa and the Prabhākara mīmāṃsakas with reference to the nature of Non-existence (Abhāva) and its knowledge.

Model solution

The debate turns on two linked questions: **what is abhāva?** and **how is it known?**

The **Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsakas** hold that non-existence is a real negative content capable of cognition. If I know that the jar is absent from the floor, the absence is not merely a linguistic convenience; it is an object structured by the relation to its counterpositive, the jar. Since perception requires contact with a present object, and inference requires a sign, Bhāṭṭa treats absence-cognition as requiring a distinct pramāṇa: **anupalabdhi**.

The **Prābhākaras** refuse both the extra ontology and the extra pramāṇa. What is directly cognized is the locus itself, unqualified by the absent object. The floor is simply presented as jar-less. Hence there is no need to introduce a separate means of knowledge.

Issue	Bhāṭṭa	Prābhākara
nature of abhāva	real negative content	no denial of the judgment, but no independent negative entity is needed
knowledge of absence	anupalabdhi	ordinary cognition of the bare locus
motivation	preserve the determinacy of negative cognition	preserve epistemic and ontological economy
main problem	multiplies pramāṇas and objects	may not fully explain the determinacy of "absence of X"

The deepest disagreement is methodological. Bhāṭṭa is willing to posit new epistemic resources when experience demands them. Prābhākara is more austere and prefers to avoid multiplication unless reduction fails completely.

Verdict: Bhāṭṭa offers the fuller account of negative cognition; Prābhākara offers the leaner account. The choice depends on whether explanatory adequacy or economy is treated as philosophically decisive.

Why this earns marks: It centers the answer on the exact two-fold debate - nature and knowledge of abhāva - and concludes with the underlying methodological contrast between the two sub-schools.

Original MCQ Bank - 32 Questions

Q	Question and options	Key	Explanation
1	Mīmāṃsā begins with: A. inquiry into dharma B. proof of God C. denial of self D. mystical union	A	The school starts from dharma-jijñāsā, not from speculative theology.
2	In the Mimamsa context, codanā means: A. memory of duty B. impelling Vedic injunction C. comparison-based cognition D. prior non-existence	B	Codanā is the command-form that makes duty action-guiding.
3	Which school accepts six pramāṇas? A. Nyāya B. Prābhākara Mīmāṃsā C. Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā D. Sāṃkhya	C	Bhāṭṭa adds anupalabdhi to the five accepted by Prābhākara.
4	Memory is denied pramāṇa-status chiefly because it: A. is always false B. depends on God C. lacks semantic fitness D. does not disclose a previously unknown object	D	Novelty is the decisive criterion.
5	Svataḥ-prāmāṇya says that cognition is: A. prima facie valid by its own occurrence B. permanently infallible C. created by language D. valid only after success	A	Intrinsic validity means default trust, not incorrigibility.
6	Parataḥ-apramāṇya means that invalidity is known through: A. intuition alone B. later contradiction or discovery of defect C. universals only D. deep sleep	B	Falsity is externally disclosed.
7	The stout Devadatta case is the classical example of: A. anupalabdhi B. anuvyavasāya C. arthāpatti D. sphoṭa	C	The conclusion is compelled explanatory postulation.
8	Nyāya's reduction of arthāpatti relies most on a prior: A. niyoga B. apūrva C. akhyāti D. vyāpti	D	It tries to convert the case into standard inference.
9	Yogyānupalabdhi requires that the absent object: A. would be perceivable if present B. be eternal C. be remembered from childhood D. be scripturally revealed	A	Non-perception counts only when perception should have occurred.
10	According to Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā, abhāva is: A. mere grammar B. a real negative content known by anupalabdhi C. impossible to cognize D. always inferential only	B	Bhāṭṭa grants both objecthood and a separate pramāṇa.
11	Tripuṭi-samvit means simultaneous manifestation of: A. three Vedas B. word, meaning and sentence C. knower, known and cognition D. duty, fruit and God	C	This is the Prābhākara answer to metacognition.
12	Jñātātā refers to the object's: A. falsity B. universality C. ritual purity D. cognizedness, from which cognition is inferred	D	Kumārila denies self-luminosity of cognition and infers it from jñātātā.
13	Akhyāti explains illusion as: A. non-discrimination between perception and memory B. divine deception C. pure non-being D. only linguistic confusion	A	Prābhākara keeps the constituent cognitions valid.
14	Viparīta-khyāti holds that illusion involves: A. only recollection B. a positive misapprehension under defect C. no cognition at all D. mere verbal error	B	Bhāṭṭa allows a false cognition without abandoning intrinsic validity.
15	Abhihitānvayavāda states that: A. words mean only particulars B. Veda has a divine author C. words first denote separate meanings and then get connected D. sentences alone are primary	C	This is the Bhāṭṭa theory of sentence meaning.
16	Anvitābhidhānavāda states that words convey: A. only remembered objects B. abstract sounds without meaning C. bare universals alone D. meanings as already connected in sentential use	D	This is the Prābhākara contextualist position.
17	Ākāṅkṣā in sentence theory means: A. mutual expectancy among words B. speaker's private intention C. absence-cognition D. non-verbal meditation	A	Without expectancy, sentence unity does not arise.

Q	Question and options	Key	Explanation
18	Mīmāṃsā generally gives semantic priority to: A. silence B. universals (jāti) C. divine intention D. impossible objects	B	Repeatable application of a word is explained through jāti.
19	Apauruṣeyatva primarily protects the Veda from: A. ritual complexity B. historical transmission C. authorial defect D. sentence-unity	C	No human or divine author means no author-based error.
20	The strongest Mimamsa reason to reject a creator-God is that God would: A. abolish perception B. destroy universals C. remove duty D. become redundant beside karma and apūrva or introduce partiality	D	This is the classic anti-theistic pressure point.
21	Śābdī bhāvanā is the: A. linguistic impelling force of the injunction B. bare-locus cognition of absence C. theory of memory D. post-mokṣa bliss	A	It explains how the Vedic word moves the agent to act.
22	Ārthī bhāvanā is the: A. eternity of words B. real productive force of the performed act C. relation between universal and particular D. later reflective cognition	B	It explains how action brings about the result.
23	Prābhākara's niyoga-vāda emphasizes: A. phala as the sole motive B. God's command C. the act as directly binding and to-be-done D. memory as duty	C	Duty arises from injunction itself, not merely from desired fruit.
24	Apūrva is best described as: A. a visible ritual fire B. a universal C. God in hidden form D. an unseen potency linking act and later fruit	D	It explains delayed ritual efficacy without theism.
25	Ritual deities in classical Mimamsa are primarily: A. mantra-denoted participants within sacrificial procedure B. creators of the world C. deniers of Veda D. equivalent to Brahman	A	They are not the sovereign dispensers of fruit.
26	Vedānta challenges Mimamsa by insisting that some Vedic sentences reveal: A. only ritual accessories B. an already accomplished reality (siddha-vastu) C. bare universals without context D. only social law	B	This marks the break between Pūrva- and Uttara-Mīmāṃsā.
27	The self in Mimamsa must be: A. momentary B. identical with language C. enduring as knower, agent and enjoyer D. unreal like illusion	C	Without continuity, karma and ritual fruit collapse.
28	Later Mimamsa mokṣa is best stated as: A. union with Īśvara B. absorption into language C. public ritual prestige D. cessation of suffering and embodiment, not Brahman-identity	D	The doctrine is largely negative and should not be Vedāntized.
29	The statement "intrinsic validity means every cognition is permanently true" is: A. false because Mimamsa allows later defeat B. true because default trust is infallible C. true only for memory D. true only for error	A	The standard trap is to confuse default validity with final indefeasibility.
30	Nyāya explains awareness of cognition through: A. apūrva B. anuvyavasāya C. codanā D. akhyāti	B	A higher-order cognition reflects on the first act of knowing.
31	In ritual hermeneutics, vākya chiefly concerns: A. the historical author B. similarity with another ritual C. sentence-unity and connected textual meaning D. deep sleep	C	Vākya is one of the ranked interpretive clues.
32	The safest one-line summary of the topic is: A. theology in search of omniscience B. skepticism about all knowledge C. mysticism without duty D. knowledge in the service of dharma	D	That formula keeps epistemology tied to language, duty and ritual action.

Rotation audit: A -> B -> C -> D repeated eight times.

Remedial Error-Correction Drills

Drill	Common wrong move	Corrective repair	Why the correction matters
1	"Intrinsic validity means no cognition can ever be false."	Say: every cognition is prima facie valid, but later defeat can reveal falsity.	This prevents infallibilist misreading.
2	"Prābhākara accepts six pramāṇas like Bhāṭṭa."	Say: Prābhākara accepts five ; Bhāṭṭa alone adds anupalabdhi .	This is one of the most repeated factual traps.
3	"Arthāpatti is just a fancy name for guesswork."	Say: it is compelled postulation produced by otherwise unresolved incompatibility.	The exam asks for its irreducible logic, not its superficial plausibility.
4	"Akhyāti means there is no cognition at all in illusion."	Say: there are valid cognitions, but their difference is not discriminated .	Without this, Prābhākara's theory collapses into absurdity.
5	"Bhāṭṭa accepts self-luminous cognition."	Say: Bhāṭṭa defends intrinsic validity but knows cognition through jñātātā .	This is the decisive distinction between manifestation and validity.
6	"Mīmāṃsā proves Veda by invoking God."	Say: it secures the Veda by excluding divine authorship and defending apauruṣeyatva .	This preserves the school's distinctive orthodoxy-without-theism.
7	"Niyoga and desire for fruit mean the same thing."	Say: Prābhākara makes obligation categorical, while Bhāṭṭa allows a stronger place for phala-motivation.	This prevents flattening the Bhāṭṭa-Prābhākara ethical divide.
8	"Mokṣa in Mimamsa is merger into Brahman."	Say: later Mimamsa generally presents mokṣa negatively, as release from pain and embodiment.	This blocks Vedāntic importation into a ritual-epistemic school.

Original Mains Practice

Practice 1 - 10 marks

Question: Explain how codanā, bhāvanā and apūrva together make Mīmāṃsā a theory of duty rather than a mere theory of knowledge.

Model solution

Codanā makes Vedic language prescriptive: dharma is known as what the Veda enjoins. **Bhāvanā** explains how that injunction works. In Bhāṭṭa terms, **śābdī bhāvanā** impels the qualified agent to act, while **ārthī bhāvanā** belongs to the actual performance that produces the result. **Apūrva** then links the visible but perishing act to a later unseen fruit.

These three ideas therefore form one chain. Codanā gives duty its linguistic form, bhāvanā gives injunction its motivational and productive structure, and apūrva secures delayed efficacy without requiring a creator-God. Without codanā, the Veda would become descriptive; without bhāvanā, command would not generate action; without apūrva, the gap between act and fruit would remain unexplained.

A Vedāntin may object that this subordinates too much scriptural meaning to action. Mīmāṃsā accepts the price because its project is not metaphysical disclosure first, but the determination of dharma.

Why this earns marks: It answers the directive through one integrated chain, uses the exact technical terms, and shows how language, action and unseen efficacy fit together.

Practice 2 - 15 marks

Question: Is Prābhākara's tripuṭī-samvit a stronger account of self-awareness than Nyāya anuvyavasāya and Bhāṭṭa jñātātā? Evaluate.

Model solution

Prābhākara's **tripuṭī-samvit** is powerful because it meets the regress objection most directly. If cognition were not somehow manifest in the very act of knowing, another cognition would be needed to reveal it, and that second cognition would need a third. By holding that knower, known and cognition are given together, Prābhākara preserves immediacy.

Against this, **Nyāya** offers **anuvyavasāya** - a second-order cognition of the form "I know the pot." Its strength is analytic clarity: it sharply separates object-knowledge from reflective awareness. Its weakness is that the regress worry does not fully disappear; one must explain why the higher-order cognition does not require a further one.

Bhāṭṭa avoids both full self-luminosity and explicit second-order reflection by appealing to **jñātātā**. Cognition is inferred from the object's cognizedness. This preserves a stronger object-realism, but critics complain that jñātātā looks like an extra entity introduced only to avoid self-manifest cognition.

Evaluation: tripuṭī-samvit is strongest if anti-regress economy is treated as decisive. Nyāya is strongest if reflective structure is prioritized. Bhāṭṭa is strongest if one wants reflexive awareness without granting self-luminous episodes. No single theory is cost-free.

Why this earns marks: It evaluates rather than merely lists, explains the different philosophical motivations, and gives a balanced verdict instead of a one-sided assertion.

Practice 3 - 20 marks

Question: Can Mīmāṃsā consistently defend an authorless Veda, deny God, and still claim objective normativity? Discuss.

Model solution

Mīmāṃsā answers this challenge by shifting the ground of normativity away from divine will and toward the objective authority of an **apauruṣeya** text. The Veda is authorless, eternal and free from the defects that plague personal testimony. Because dharma is supersensible, no ordinary pramāṇa can independently generate it; Vedic injunction is therefore uniquely authoritative in its own domain.

Normativity enters through **codanā** and **niyoga / bhāvanā**. A Vedic sentence is not merely descriptive but action-guiding. Duty binds because the injunction itself presents an act as to-be-done for a qualified agent. This impersonal model removes dependence on a lawgiver. The later fruit of obedience is explained by **apūrva**, the unseen potency produced by correct action. Thus Mīmāṃsā can deny a creator-God while still offering a structured account of obligation and efficacy.

The position is internally coherent, but not unproblematic. **Nyāya** objects that meaning and authority are easier to understand if grounded in an omniscient author. **Buddhist** critics deny eternal words and natural word-meaning relations. **Advaita** objects that not all Vedic meaning is injunctive, since Upaniṣadic statements reveal an accomplished reality. Further, critics may ask whether apūrva and authorless language are explanatory successes or theoretical devices designed to rescue ritualism.

Yet Mīmāṃsā has a real philosophical achievement: it shows that objective normativity need not be equated with divine command. A text can bind, on this model, because of its impersonal validity, stable semantic force and exclusive access to a supersensible domain.

Verdict: within its own realist and hermeneutic presuppositions, Mīmāṃsā can consistently defend objective normativity without God. Its deepest vulnerability lies not in inconsistency, but in the contested assumptions of eternal language and unseen efficacy.

Why this earns marks: It reconstructs the system's internal coherence, brings in rival objections, and ends with a graded verdict that distinguishes inconsistency from contestability.

FINAL CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

Orientation and textual base

- Pūrva-Mīmāṃsā = inquiry into **dharma**, not first into Brahman or God.
- Jaimini gives the sūtra-frame; Śabara grounds classical exegesis.
- Kumārila = Bhāṭṭa line; Prabhākara = Prābhākara line.
- Chatterjee-Datta formula: Mīmāṃsā serves ritualism by **method of interpretation + philosophical defense**.
- Fast identity line: **knowledge in the service of duty**.

Dharma, codanā and ritual efficacy

- codana- laksano ' rtho dharmah = dharma is known through Vedic injunction.
- **Vidhi** enjoins; **niṣedha** prohibits.
- **Śābdī bhāvanā** impels the agent; **ārthī bhāvanā** is productive activity.
- **Apūrva** links act and future fruit.
- **Niyoga** = directly binding “to-be-done,” especially in Prābhākara.
- **Aṃśa-traya** = what, by what means, and how.

Validity and pramāṇas

- **Svataḥ-prāmāṇya** = intrinsic validity; **parataḥ-apramāṇya** = extrinsic invalidity.
- Belief is normal; disbelief is exceptional.
- Nyāya counter = parataḥ-prāmāṇya through validation.
- Pramāṇas:
- Prābhākara = 5
- Bhāṭṭa = 6
- Memory is excluded because it lacks novelty, not because it is always false.

Arthāpatti and anupalabdhi

- **Arthāpatti** = explanatory necessity, not guess.
- Standard example: stout Devadatta who does not eat by day -> must eat at night.
- **Anupalabdhi** = non-perception of what would be perceived if present.
- **Yogyatā** is decisive.
- Bhāṭṭa grants abhāva real objecthood and a separate pramāṇa; Prābhākara chooses economy.

Self-awareness and error

Problem	Prābhākara	Bhāṭṭa	Nyāya
cognition of cognition	tripuṭī-samvit	jñātātā-inference	anuvyavasāya
illusion	akhyāti	viparīta-khyāti	anyathā-khyāti

- Akhyāti = non-discrimination between valid perception and valid memory.
- Viparīta-khyāti = positive misapprehension under defect.
- Shell-silver is the standard test-case.

Word and sentence meaning

- Sentence-unity depends on **ākāṅkṣā**, **yogyatā**, **sannidhi**.
- **Abhihitānvayavāda**: words first denote separately, then connect.
- **Anvitābhīdhānavāda**: words denote already-connected meanings.
- Mīmāṃsā generally prioritizes **jāti**; Nyāya prioritizes qualified **vyakti**.
- Ritual hermeneutics: **śruti**, **liṅga**, **vākya**, **prakaraṇa**, **sthāna**, **samākhyā**, plus **utsarga-apavāda**.

Veda, God and normativity

- Veda = **apauruṣeya** and, in the relevant sense, eternal.
- Word-meaning relation = **autpattika**, not merely conventional.
- Mīmāṃsā rejects creator-God and fruit-dispenser God.
- Karma + apūrva do the explanatory work.
- Ritual deities remain inside procedure, but are not sovereign dispensers of result.

Self, world, karma and mokṣa

- World is real.
- Self is enduring knower, agent and enjoyer.
- Ritual fruit presupposes continuity of self.
- Later mokṣa = cessation of pain and embodiment; do not import Advaita's Brahman-identity.
- Early stress remains stronger on **dharma** and **svarga**.

PYQ route map

- 2018: self-luminosity versus intrinsic validity.
- 2019: Vedic authority.
- 2020: memory not pramāṇa.
- 2021: abhāva and its knowledge.
- 2022: arthāpatti vs inference; error within intrinsic validity.
- 2023: anupalabdhi; universals versus particulars.
- 2024: sentence meaning; metacognition; candidate-success case; memory again.
- 2025: intrinsic vs extrinsic validation; Bhāṭṭa-Prābhākara absence debate.

Answer spines

10 marks: define -> standard example -> rival contrast -> one-line criticism -> direct verdict.

15 marks: frame the issue -> mechanism in steps -> example -> objection/reply -> qualified conclusion.

20 marks: conceptual distinction -> full reconstruction -> Bhāṭṭa/Prābhākara split -> Nyāya/Advaita comparison -> deepest criticism -> graded verdict.

Final traps

1. Prābhākara is **five-pramāṇa**, not six-pramāṇa.
2. Intrinsic validity is not infallibility.
3. Bhāṭṭa denies self-luminous cognition but keeps intrinsic validity.
4. Arthāpatti is not mere guess.
5. Anupalabdhi is Bhāṭṭa's distinct contribution.
6. Akhyāti is not no-cognition.
7. Mīmāṃsā does not need God to ground Veda.
8. Sentence meaning debate and universal-particular debate must not be collapsed.
9. Apūrva is not visible causation and not God-in-disguise.

10. Mimamsa optional answers score best when they keep **epistemology, language and duty** together.